

Welcome to the official Prado Systems user guide, the core engine specifically designed to streamline plant production, dispatch logistics, customer CRM, subcontractor management, and financial administration within a single, unified environment. This document highlights critical operational workflows and answers frequently asked questions regarding our platform layout.

1. Step-by-Step Critical Workflows

A. Commercial Management: From Opportunity to Production

1. Customer Registration in CRM: Access the Customer CRM module on the left panel. Register customer profiles, contact histories, tax settings, and operational requirements.
2. Drafting Quotes: Head over to the Quotes section. Build detailed cost proposals specifying requested materials, architectural coatings, paint formulations, and labor, generating a clear digital quote for your customer.
3. Digital Approval: Present the quote to your customer. Once confirmed and internally validated, update the quote status to approved.
4. Direct Conversion to Job: With the approved quote, the platform automatically enables the option to push operational details into the plant scheduling module as an active Job. This eliminates duplicate data entry and accelerates the value chain.

B. Plant Execution, Subcontractor Management & Dispatch Logistics

1. Operational Planning (Job Scheduling): Transferred Jobs immediately appear on the master task scheduler. Supervisors can allocate each Job to specific operators, mixing tanks, or production shifts.
2. Subcontractor Allocation & Permissions: Assign third-party subcontractors to specialized Jobs, scope their portal access via dedicated permission roles, and track job profitability and margins in real time.
3. Real-Time Status Tracking: As the team progresses through color matching or batch manufacturing, task statuses for the Job update in real time until marked as completed.
4. Dispatch Route & Vehicle Optimization: Finalized production batches are consolidated within the dispatch module. Logistics managers build efficient delivery routes and assign dedicated fleet Vehicles, generating manifests for drivers.

C. Financial Cycle and Accounting Synchronization

1. Invoice Issuance & Stripe Online Payments: Once product delivery is confirmed, issue the Invoice. Integrated Stripe Connect payment links allow customers to pay receivables instantly online via credit card or digital wallet.
2. Plant Outlay & Expense Tracking: Record procurement of supplies, raw material purchases, machinery servicing, or subcontractor outlays directly in the Expense Ledger.
3. Automated Accounting Link (QuickBooks & Xero): Through secure integrations with platforms like QuickBooks Online (QBO) and Xero, logged inlays and outlays can be dispatched with a single click as bill and invoice drafts directly inside your accounting backend.

Efficiency & Operational Control Note:

All financial metrics, Job progress, Stripe payment statuses, and subcontractor margins consolidated across these workflows are aggregated instantly inside the Prado Overview Terminal, providing high-level performance insights at a single glance.

2. Frequently Asked Questions and Workspace Structure

How does Prado scale with the size of my organization?

Prado is built on a highly flexible model. We offer tailored service tiers suitable for independent contractors operating solo, optimized environments for growing workshops connecting teams of up to 5 user roles, and unlimited enterprise solutions for mid-sized to large organizations managing complex multi-department frameworks.

How does financial integration handle secure data syncing and digital payments?

Prado leverages advanced OAuth 2.0 protocols to connect externally with Stripe Connect for instant customer invoice payments, as well as accounting platforms like QuickBooks Online (QBO) and Xero. This guarantees encrypted data exchange without storing critical banking credentials.

What access roles are available for my team members?

To safeguard workspace security, Prado features 6 clearly defined access profiles:

- Owner: Full access to the workspace, global system settings, and subscription management.
- Manager: Workspace-wide visibility, team member administration, and operational adjustments.
- Supervisor / Coordinator: Active day-to-day coordination capabilities (CRM, Quotes, Job Scheduling).
- Subcontractor: Scoped access restricted specifically to assigned Jobs, progress updates, and task completion.
- Accountant: Specialized access to invoice lifecycles, expense ledgers, Stripe Connect, and QBO/Xero accounting sync.
- Analyst / Observer: Secure read-only profile ideal for external audits or passive monitoring of metrics.

Does Prado feature built-in guidance and support?

Yes. Prado includes an interactive How-To Library and an automated Helpdesk Assistant directly in the user interface to assist users with step-by-step guidance.

Can I migrate historical business data into Prado?

Yes. Utilizing the Import / Export module, administrators can batch-upload customer directories and initial inventory sheets using standard CSV or spreadsheet formats, ensuring a fast and smooth transition.